



LEANDER MENA | F&B OPERATIONS CONSULTING

Banquet and Events Build-Out

Launch or reset a hotel banquet and catering department

For hotels and venues opening a banquet department or fixing one that is leaving revenue on the table. Workflows, staffing, standards, and event execution built from the ground up.

THE PROBLEM

Banquets are a profit center when the system is right

Banquet departments live or die on process: BEOs that are accurate, staffing that matches the event, service standards that hold at 500 guests, and a sales handoff that does not drop details.

I built the banquet department at SLS Brickell before opening day, including a grand opening for about 1,800 guests. I ran banquets and events at Viceroy Miami and Club Fifty, coordinated 150+ weddings and corporate events a year at The Palms on Miami Beach, and wrote the banquet procedures that carried Sofitel Miami through its conversion to Pullman Miami Airport.

Every wedding is somebody's most important day. The system has to hold up at that standard every time.

THE METHOD

How the work runs

Banquet build-outs follow the same three phases.

PHASE 01

Review

Event spaces, sales process, BEO flow, staffing, and current standards.

PHASE 02

Build

Workflows, staffing model, training, service standards, and event execution procedures.

PHASE 03

Run

Lead live events with the team, refine, then hand off to your banquet leadership.

20 YEARS ON THE FLOOR

20

years in hospitality

1,800

guest hotel grand opening

5,000+

hotel rooms served in-room
dining

\$180K+

saved per year in purchasing

SERVICES

What is included

01 Department Design

Org chart, staffing model, and on-call pool built around your event calendar.

02 BEO and Sales Handoff

Clear flow from catering sales to operations so details never drop.

03 Service Standards

Plated, buffet, and reception standards trained and checked.

04 Event Execution Procedures

Timelines, room sets, run of show, and post-event review.

05 Beverage and Purchasing

Banquet beverage programs and purchasing consolidated across outlets.

06 Training Program

Captain and server training so standards hold on the biggest nights.

WHAT I LOOK FOR

What I look at first

Sales to operations handoff

Are BEOs complete and on time?

Staffing model

Is labor scheduled to the event, or to habit?

Standards

Are service standards written and trained?

Spaces and equipment

Do room sets, equipment, and storage support the events you sell?

Purchasing

Is beverage and food purchasing coordinated across banquets and outlets?

The findings set the order of the work, starting with what protects upcoming events.

Engagement options

ENGAGEMENT	SCOPE	TIMELINE
Banquet Assessment	Review of process, staffing, and standards with written findings.	1 to 2 weeks
Department Build-Out	Full build or reset, including training and live events.	6 to 12 weeks
Opening Support	Banquet department as part of a hotel pre-opening.	Scoped to opening

THE GROUNDWORK BINDER

What you keep

You keep the full banquet operating system:

- Banquet SOPs and service standards
- BEO templates and sales handoff process
- Staffing model and training materials
- Event timelines and run-of-show templates
- Purchasing and par guides

Investment

Custom quote

Scoped to property size and event volume. Often paired with Pre-Opening or Operations Consulting.

IDEAL FOR

Who this fits

- Hotels opening a banquet department
- Venues growing weddings and corporate events
- Brand conversions
- Banquet teams with service or cost issues

Next step

Book a discovery call to walk through your spaces and event calendar.

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NOT READY FOR AN ENGAGEMENT?

The Banquet and Events toolkit (\$47) and the SOP Core Collection (\$97) are available at menaconsulting.gumroad.com for teams who want to start on their own.